

User Stories

Feature requirements written from each user role's perspective, grouped by project epic.

Program	Diploma in Advanced AI & Software Engineering
Batch	25/26
Project	Smart Hire — Service Marketplace
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User stories are grouped by the same epics used to plan and track the work on the project's Jira board (project CCSHP).

1. Frontend / Customer Experience

CUSTOMER

As a customer, I want to search and filter services by category, city, and price, so that I can quickly find the right professional.

Acceptance criteria: Results update live as filters change; empty state shown when nothing matches.

CUSTOMER

As a customer, I want to see a service's real photo, price, and provider rating on its card, so that I can compare options at a glance.

Acceptance criteria: Card shows a topical photo (falls back to a category icon if the photo fails to load), price in LKR, and star rating.

CUSTOMER

As a customer, I want to save services to a favourites list, so that I can find them again later.

Acceptance criteria: Heart icon toggles saved state; favourites page lists only saved services.

CUSTOMER

As a new user, I want a clear error message if I enter the wrong password, so that I know to try again instead of seeing a stuck spinner.

Acceptance criteria: Login shows a specific error and stops loading on a 401 response.

2. Backend / Bookings & Services

CUSTOMER

As a customer, I want to request a booking for a future date and time, so that I can hire a provider for a specific job.

Acceptance criteria: Booking is rejected if the date isn't in the future; provider is notified immediately.

PROVIDER

As a provider, I want to accept or reject a booking request, so that I control my own schedule.

Acceptance criteria: Only the assigned provider can act on the request; customer is notified of the outcome.

PROVIDER

As a provider, I want to set my weekly availability, so that customers and the AI assistant only see times I can actually work.

Acceptance criteria: Availability check subtracts already-booked times from the provider's declared weekly windows.

3. Database

PROVIDER

As a provider, I want my verification status to be stored and shown to customers, so that verified providers stand out.

Acceptance criteria: Verification status lives on the provider profile and is reflected on every service card, not hardcoded.

CUSTOMER

As a customer, I want my booking history preserved even if a service is later removed, so that my records stay accurate.

Acceptance criteria: Bookings reference the service and provider by id with proper foreign keys and cascade rules.

4. AI Feature Integration

CUSTOMER

As a customer, I want to describe my problem in plain language and get a matching service category and real providers, so that I don't have to browse manually.

Acceptance criteria: Recommendation is chosen from real, active categories and services, never invented.

CUSTOMER

As a customer, I want to ask the AI assistant to check a provider's availability and book them, so that I can do it in one conversation.

Acceptance criteria: Assistant only books after I explicitly confirm the service, date, and time.

PROVIDER

As a provider, I want an AI-written summary of my reviews, so that I can see common themes without reading every one.

Acceptance criteria: Summary is generated only from that provider's own real review comments.

5. Testing & Quality Assurance

DEVELOPMENT TEAM

As a developer, I want an automated test suite for the backend and frontend, so that regressions are caught before release.

Acceptance criteria: 48 automated tests (24 backend, 24 frontend) run in isolation with no real network calls.

DEVELOPMENT TEAM

As a developer, I want a smoke test against the real running system, so that I can verify a full user journey end to end before a demo.

Acceptance criteria: Smoke test creates and cleans up its own throwaway accounts against the live backend.

6. Version Control & Deployment

DEVELOPMENT TEAM

As a team, we want a feature branch per contributor with pull requests into main, so that changes are reviewed before merging.

Acceptance criteria: Every merge into main happens through a reviewed pull request, visible in Git history.

7. Project Planning & Documentation

DEVELOPMENT TEAM

As a team, we want a Jira board broken into epics and tasks, so that our project management is visible and assessable.

Acceptance criteria: Board reflects real, current progress across all epics, with tasks assigned to the person who did the work.

8. Presentation & Viva Preparation

DEVELOPMENT TEAM

As a team, we want every member to be able to explain any part of the system, so that we're prepared for individual viva questioning.

Acceptance criteria: Each member can walk through the architecture, database, APIs, and their own contributions from scratch.